

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Is fish farming the answer to overfishing?



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you eat fish? Why or why not?
- What do you know about where the fish you eat comes from?

Can Do Statements

- I can describe social and urban change, and environmental problems.
- I can talk about things that happened.
- I can talk about things that are happening and things that have happened.

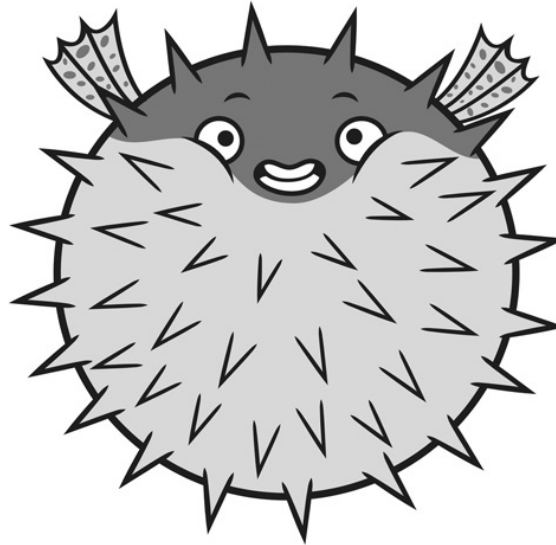




Let's Explore!

Let's read about overfishing - the best solution is **to raise awareness***.

* "To raise awareness" means to make an issue more known to people in hopes of making a difference.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

For years now, we have been told by environmentalists about the dangers of overfishing in the world's oceans. Species of fish are being wiped out. Now that so many fish are becoming extinct, the time has come to find an alternative. Is fish farming the answer? Environmentalists say no.

Fish farming is a multi-million dollar industry that produces one-third of the fish eaten in the world today. For a long time, people thought it was the solution to the problem of overfishing.

Unfortunately, the young fish used in commercial fish farms are taken straight from the sea. They are also being fed ocean fish, such as anchovies and mackerel. It takes about five pounds of fish from the ocean to raise one pound of farmed fish. Fish farming is helping to decrease the numbers in certain species of fish in the sea.

According to some environmental groups, the environment is being harmed by fish farming. Fish farms create animal waste and dangerous chemicals. These have been dumped directly into the coastal waters nearby and the biological life there is being endangered.

"Fish farming is not the answer to feeding the world's population," said a well-known environmentalist. "It should be prohibited. We have to protect ocean life, and the best solution is to raise awareness and to encourage people to change their eating habits."





Let's Practice!

We need to raise awareness about fish farming.

Instructions: Read the sentences below and circle the incorrect words. Practice saying the sentences aloud with a partner. Correct each other's pronunciation.

1. For a long time, people are thought it was the solution to the problem of overfishing.
2. "Fish farming is not the answer to feeding the world's population," say a well-known environmentalist.
3. Fisheries taked young fish straight from the ocean.
4. Companies did wasted large amounts of fish.
5. Governments prohibit fish farming up until ten years ago.



Let's Practice!

Let's talk about environmental issues.

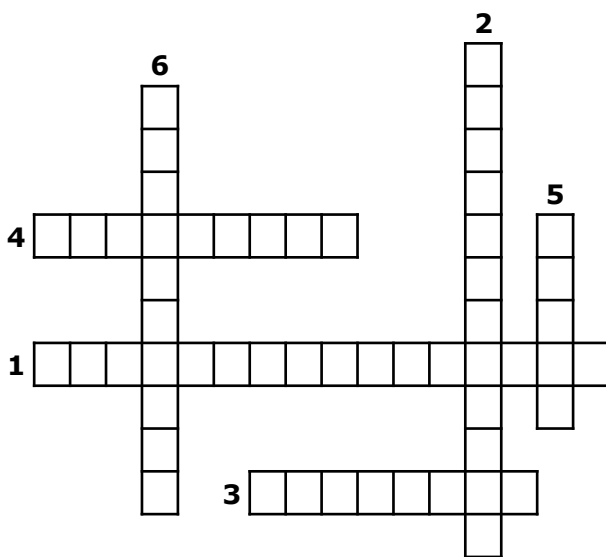
Instructions: Find the missing words in the crossword. Use the words to write sentences. Model a conversation with a partner using the sentences. Switch roles.

Down

2. Fish farming is a _____ dollar industry.
5. Fish farms create animal _____ and dangerous chemicals.
6. Fish farming should be _____.

Across

1. We have been told by _____ about the dangers of overfishing.
3. Fish farming produces _____ of the fish eaten in the world today.
4. They are also being fed ocean fish, such _____ and mackerel.





Extension Activity

Visit your local fish store.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Visit your local fish store and find out where the fish is caught or farmed.
- Talk to the salesperson about the fish. Find out as much information as you can.
- Write notes in English about what you discovered.
- Share and discuss the information with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I visit my local fish store.

☐
☐

I talk to them about the fish and where it is from.

☐
☐

I gather as much information as I can.

☐
☐

I share and discuss the information with a partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- environmentalist** (noun): a person who is interested in learning about and protecting the environment
e.g. We have been told by environmentalists about the dangers of overfishing.
- overfishing** (noun): making the number of fish too low by taking too many fish from waterways
e.g. Overfishing threatens marine life.
- multi-million dollar** (adjective): costing millions of dollars
e.g. Fish farming is a multi-million dollar industry.
- one-third** (noun): one of three equal parts
e.g. Fish farming produces one-third of the fish eaten in the world today.
- anchovy** (noun): a very small fish that tastes strongly of salt
e.g. Anchovies and mackerel feed some ocean fish.
- waste** (noun): unwanted materials or substances that are left after you have used something
e.g. Fish farms create animal waste and dangerous chemicals.
- prohibited** (adjective): not allowed
e.g. Fish farming should be prohibited.





Learning Points

The Passive: The Present Continuous and Present Perfect Tenses

You use the **Present Continuous** to talk about an action that is happening at the time of speaking. The action or event is in progress.

*Now that so many fish **are becoming** extinct, the time has come to find an alternative.*

You use the **Present Perfect** to talk about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present.

*The time **has come** to find an alternative.*

You often choose the passive form when you want to talk about an action but are not so interested in saying who or what does/did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in academic and scientific writing.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the passive voice.

Name	Structure	Example
Present Continuous	<i>am/are/is + being + past participle</i>	<i>Species of fish are being wiped out.</i>
Present Perfect	<i>have/has + been + past participle</i>	<i>These have been dumped directly into the coastal waters nearby and the biological life there is being endangered.</i>

Examples:

- *For years now, we have been told by environmentalists about the dangers of overfishing in the world's oceans.*
- *Species of fish are being wiped out.*
- *Now that so many fish are becoming extinct, the time has come to find an alternative.*
- *They are also being fed ocean fish, such as anchovies and mackerel.*





Learning Points

The Simple Past Tense

You use the **Simple Past** tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

Usually, when you use the **Simple Past** tense, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

*For a long time, people **thought** it was the solution to the problem of overfishing.*

Here is another example:

*"Fish farming is not the answer to feeding the world's population," **said** a well-known environmentalist.*

Remember that there are both regular and irregular verbs. Look at the chart for examples of the **Simple Past** tense verbs.

Regular Verb		Irregular Verb	
Present	Past	Present	Past
discover	discovered	think	thought
recognize	recognized	say	said

Examples:

- *For a long time, people **thought** it was the solution to the problem of overfishing.*
- *"Fish farming is not the answer to feeding the world's population," **said** a well-known environmentalist.*

